



01 | Who I Am: Core Identity & Values



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1.1 Introduction and Core Values

Welcome to my user manual. This isn't a cry for help or a set of rules. It's a tool for mutual understanding.

I'm Cody — also known to some as Angela. I've lived many lives in one body: creative, business-minded, spiritual, and raw. I'm transgender, transitioning without medical intervention. I'm rebuilding from layers of trauma, burnout, and abandonment. My journey is deeply human — and if you're in it with me, thank you.

In this guide, I'm inviting you into a deeper understanding of who I am — not to excuse, explain, or convince, but to make space for empathy, collaboration, and authentic connection. I believe that transparency, flexibility, and trust can transform the way we relate to one another — especially when neurodivergence, trauma, or personal challenges are in the mix.

Like many, I navigate a mix of visible and invisible conditions:

- ADHD
 - Time management challenges
 - ▼ time-blindness
 - Time-blindness is a common ADHD symptom that affects a person's ability to accurately perceive and manage time. It can manifest as:
 - Difficulty estimating how long tasks will take
 - Losing track of time while engaged in activities
 - Struggling to plan ahead for future events
 - Frequently running late or missing deadlines

- difficulty estimating task duration
- frequently running late
- **Focus irregularities**
 - hyperfocus on engaging tasks
 - difficulty maintaining attention
 - easily distracted
- **Executive function challenges**
 - task initiation difficulties
 - organization struggles
 - working memory issues
- anxiety
 - excessive worry and overthinking
 - physical symptoms like tension and restlessness
 - difficulty with uncertainty
 - social anxiety in certain situations
- PTSD
 - flashbacks and intrusive memories
 - hypervigilance
 - avoidance behaviors
 - emotional numbness
- depression
 - persistent low mood
 - loss of interest in activities
 - changes in sleep and appetite
 - difficulty concentrating
- phonophobia
 - fear of loud sounds
 - anxiety in noisy environments
 - sound sensitivity
- correspondence anxiety
 - difficulty responding to messages
 - overwhelm with communication
 - delayed responses
- sleep-related challenges like

- delayed sleep phase
 - difficulty falling asleep at conventional times
 - natural late-night alertness
- sleep inertia
 - extreme difficulty waking up
 - extended morning grogginess
- the layered experience of being a transgender person of color
 - intersectional identity challenges
 - navigating multiple minority experiences
 - dealing with compound discrimination

These intersect in ways that shape my routines, relationships, and daily functioning. I don't need sympathy. I need understanding, consistency, and thoughtful collaboration.

When you engage with me through this lens — not as a puzzle to solve but a person to meet — it helps both of us succeed.

1.2 What Matters to Me

- Protecting peace like it's sacred
- Honesty, even when it's uncomfortable
- Flexibility over rigidity
- Deep connections, not surface-level ties
- Building safe systems for unsafe people

1.3 Basic Info, Personality & Communication Style

Processing and Communication Style

1. As someone with ADHD and being neurodivergent, Cody needs additional time to process information thoroughly before responding. This isn't a sign of disengagement, but rather a thoughtful approach to communication.



Think of it like a computer processing a complex task - sometimes it needs a moment to organize the information properly. For example, during meetings, they might take notes and need a moment to gather their thoughts before contributing to the discussion.

2. Direct and explicit communication is strongly preferred, as they may miss certain social cues. This straightforward approach helps avoid misunderstandings and ensures clear communication.



For instance, instead of hinting "the room is a bit warm," it's better to directly say "Could you please open a window?"

When someone says "let's meet soon," Cody appreciates specific suggestions like "How about next Tuesday at 2 PM?"

Energy Management and Boundaries

1. Cody uses silence as a way to protect energy and process thoughts, which is particularly important for managing ADHD, anxiety, and PTSD symptoms.
2. They prioritize peace and energy conservation, which is crucial for maintaining mental health and managing multiple conditions.



For example, after a long meeting, they might need 30 minutes of quiet time to decompress and recharge before engaging in another social interaction. This might mean declining last-minute social invitations or setting specific "do not disturb" hours for focused work.

Identity and Connection

1. As a transgender person who is transitioning without medical intervention, Cody navigates multiple intersecting experiences including being neurodivergent and a person of color. They approach relationships with a focus on trust and loyalty, valuing integrity and radical honesty.



In practice, this means they might need to explain their pronouns multiple times in professional settings, while simultaneously managing sensory overload in a busy office environment. For instance, if they need to reschedule a meeting due to being overwhelmed, they'll directly communicate this rather than making up an excuse.

Growth and Values

1. Cody approaches life through a lens of growth and learning rather than seeking perfection. When they make a mistake, like missing a social cue in a conversation, they view it as an opportunity to learn and adjust rather than a personal failure.
2. They show particular compassion for others who are misunderstood, especially neurodivergent individuals and survivors.



For example, if they notice a colleague struggling with sensory overload during a busy office event, they might quietly offer them a pair of noise-canceling headphones or suggest a quieter space to work.